

Daily Cloud Security Brief

May 22, 2025

US indicts leader of Qakbot botnet linked to ransomware attacks

1. Summary: The United States has indicted Rustam Rafailevich Gallyamov, a Russian national, for leading the Qakbot botnet operation. This massive botnet, compromising over 700,000 computers worldwide, served as a crucial tool for facilitating widespread ransomware attacks. The indictment highlights a significant effort to dismantle a major cybercrime infrastructure.

Hackers use fake Ledger apps to steal Mac users' seed phrases

1. Summary: Hackers are distributing malicious applications disguised as legitimate Ledger cryptocurrency wallet software on macOS. These fake apps aim to steal users' seed phrases, the secret key that grants access to their cryptocurrency holdings. This allows criminals to gain control of and empty the victims' wallets.

Police arrests 270 dark web vendors, buyers in global crackdown

1. Summary: Operation RapTor, a multinational law enforcement operation, resulted in the arrest of 270 individuals across ten countries. These arrests targeted both vendors and buyers operating on the dark web.

Akamai, Microsoft Disagree on Severity of Unpatched 'BadSuccessor' Flaw

1. Summary: Akamai Technologies has publicly disclosed a privilege escalation vulnerability, dubbed "BadSuccessor," affecting Windows Server 2022. Microsoft has chosen not to immediately release a patch, leading to a disagreement between the two companies regarding the severity of the flaw.

Marlboro-Chesterfield Pathology Data Breach Impacts 235,000 People

1. Summary: Marlboro-Chesterfield Pathology experienced a data breach caused by the SafePay ransomware group. The attackers stole personal information from the pathology's systems.

Marks & Spencer Expects Ransomware Attack to Cost \$400 Million

1. Summary: Marks & Spencer (M&S), a major UK retailer, has been hit by a ransomware attack that is expected to cause significant disruption lasting into July. The company anticipates the attack will cost them approximately \$400 million.

3am Ransomware Adopts Email Bombing, Vishing Combo Attack

1. Summary: The ransomware group 3am is employing a combined email bombing and vishing (voice phishing) attack strategy to gain initial access to victim systems before deploying ransomware. This tactic mirrors techniques already used by other prominent ransomware groups like Black Basta.

CISA: Russia's Fancy Bear Targeting Logistics, IT Firms

1. Summary: The Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) has issued a warning about the Russian hacking group, Fancy Bear (also known as APT28 and Strontium), targeting logistics and IT firms. The group's goal is to collect intelligence to support Russia's military efforts in Ukraine.

Blurring Lines Between Scattered Spider and Russian Cybercrime

1. Summary: The hacking group Scattered Spider, previously known for its more independent operations, is increasingly collaborating with ransomware gangs, suggesting a strengthening connection to the Russian cybercrime ecosystem. This shift in affiliation raises concerns about the group's potential ties to Russian-based criminal organizations.

Top 5 Takeaways

1. 1. Ransomware remains a critical threat: Multiple incidents highlight the persistent and evolving nature of ransomware attacks, impacting both large corporations (Marks & Spencer) and smaller organizations (Marlboro-Chesterfield Pathology). Focus on robust patching, multi-factor authentication, and proactive threat hunting.

2.

3. 2. Supply chain attacks are prevalent: The Qakbot botnet's scale demonstrates the devastating impact of compromised

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third-party vendors. Prioritize supply chain security assessments and vendor risk management.

4.

5. 3. Phishing and malicious apps remain highly effective: Fake Ledger apps targeting cryptocurrency users and email bombing/vishing techniques used by 3am ransomware underscore the need for strong employee security awareness training and robust email security solutions.

6.

7. 4. Geopolitical tensions fuel cyberattacks: CISA's warning about Russian state-sponsored attacks targeting logistics and IT firms highlights the need for increased vigilance and proactive threat intelligence monitoring, particularly within critical infrastructure sectors.

8.

9. 5. Patching discrepancies create vulnerabilities: The disagreement between Akamai and Microsoft on the severity of the "BadSuccessor" flaw underscores the challenge of timely patching and the importance of independent security assessments to identify and mitigate critical vulnerabilities.